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Class ClassNotFoundException

java.lang.Object
  java.lang.Throwable
    java.lang.Exception
      java.lang.ReflectiveOperationException
        java.lang.ClassNotFoundException

All Implemented Interfaces:

Serializable

```
public class ClassNotFoundException
extends ReflectiveOperationException
```

Thrown when an application tries to load in a class through its string name using:

- The `forName` method in class `Class`.
- The `findSystemClass` method in class `ClassLoader` .
- The `loadClass` method in class `ClassLoader`.

but no definition for the class with the specified name could be found.

As of release 1.4, this exception has been retrofitted to conform to the general purpose exception-chaining mechanism. The "optional exception that was raised while loading the class" that may be provided at construction time and accessed via the `getException()` method is now known as the *cause*, and may be accessed via the `Throwable.getCause()` method, as well as the aforementioned "legacy method."

Since:

`JDK1.0`

See Also:

Class.forName(java.lang.String),
ClassLoader.findSystemClass(java.lang.String),
ClassLoader.loadClass(java.lang.String, boolean), Serialized Form

Constructor Summary

Constructors

Constructor	Description
`ClassNotFoundException()`	Constructs a `ClassNotFoundException` with no detail message.
`ClassNotFoundException(String s)`	Constructs a `ClassNotFoundException` with the specified detail message.
`ClassNotFoundException(String s, Throwable ex)`	Constructs a `ClassNotFoundException` with the specified detail message and optional exception that was raised while loading the class.

Method Summary

Concrete Methods

Modifier and Type	Method	Description
`Throwable`	`getCause()`	Returns the cause of this exception (the exception that was raised if an error occurred while attempting to load the class; otherwise `null`).
`Throwable`	`getException()`	Returns the exception that was raised if an error occurred while attempting to load the class.

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Throwable

addSuppressed, fillInStackTrace, getLocalizedMessage, getMessage, getStackTrace, getSuppressed, initCause, printStackTrace, printStackTrace, printStackTrace, setStackTrace, toString

Methods inherited from class java.lang.Object

clone, equals, finalize, getClass, hashCode, notify, notifyAll, wait, wait, wait

Constructor Detail

ClassNotFoundException

```
public ClassNotFoundException()
```

Constructs a ClassNotFoundException with no detail message.

ClassNotFoundException

```
public ClassNotFoundException(String s)
```

Constructs a ClassNotFoundException with the specified detail message.

Parameters:

s - the detail message.

ClassNotFoundException

```
public ClassNotFoundException(String s,
                              Throwable ex)
```

Constructs a ClassNotFoundException with the specified detail message and optional exception that was raised while loading the class.

Parameters:

s - the detail message

ex - the exception that was raised while loading the class

Since:

1.2

Method Detail

getException

```
public Throwable getException()
```

Returns the exception that was raised if an error occurred while attempting to load the class. Otherwise, returns `null`.

This method predates the general-purpose exception chaining facility. The `Throwable.getCause()` method is now the preferred means of obtaining this information.

Returns:

the Exception that was raised while loading a class

Since:

1.2

getCause

```
public Throwable getCause()
```

Returns the cause of this exception (the exception that was raised if an error occurred while attempting to load the class; otherwise `null`).

Overrides:

`getCause` in class `Throwable`

Returns:

the cause of this exception.

Since:

1.4

Submit a bug or feature
For further API reference and developer documentation, see Java SE Documentation. That documentation contains more detailed, developer-targeted descriptions, with conceptual overviews, definitions of terms, workarounds, and working code examples.
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